

Terrorism in Bangladesh: Advanced Quiz

Topic: Terror Attacks and Bangladesh | Difficulty: Hard | Questions: 5 | Model: gemini-2.5-flash

1. Following the Holey Artisan Bakery attack in July 2016, while ISIS claimed responsibility internationally, Bangladeshi authorities primarily attributed the attack to a specific domestic militant faction. Which group did the Bangladeshi government identify as the primary perpetrator?

- A. Jama'atul Mujahideen Bangladesh (JMB)
- B. Ansar al-Islam (AAI)
- C. New JMB (Neo-JMB) (correct)**
- D. Harkat-ul-Jihad al-Islami Bangladesh (HuJI-B)

Explanation: Bangladeshi authorities identified a faction known as 'New JMB' or 'Neo-JMB' as the primary perpetrator of the Holey Artisan Bakery attack. This faction had pledged allegiance to ISIS, leading to the international claim, but was considered a localized entity by the government.

2. In August 2005, Bangladesh experienced an unprecedented coordinated series of nearly 500 bomb blasts across 63 of its 64 districts within a span of 30 minutes. Which militant organization was responsible for this widespread act of terror, marking a significant escalation in domestic extremism?

- A. Ansarullah Bangla Team (ABT)
- B. Jama'atul Mujahideen Bangladesh (JMB) (correct)**
- C. Hizb-ut Tahrir Bangladesh
- D. Harkat-ul-Jihad al-Islami Bangladesh (HuJI-B)

Explanation: The Jama'atul Mujahideen Bangladesh (JMB) was responsible for the coordinated countrywide bombings on August 17, 2005. This event demonstrated the group's organizational capacity and marked a significant turning point in Bangladesh's struggle against domestic terrorism.

3. Ansar al-Islam (formerly Ansarullah Bangla Team - ABT) gained notoriety in Bangladesh for a specific pattern of terror attacks. What was the primary target demographic and method employed by this group that distinguished its early operations?

- A. Bombings of public infrastructure targeting government officials.
- B. Coordinated attacks on religious minority festivals.
- C. Assassinations of secular bloggers, writers, and publishers using machetes. (correct)**
- D. Hostage-taking incidents in diplomatic zones.

Explanation: Ansar al-Islam (formerly ABT) became infamous for its targeted assassinations of secular bloggers, writers, and publishers, often carried out with machetes, reflecting its extremist ideology against perceived blasphemy and atheism.

4. In response to the escalating threat of domestic and transnational terrorism, the Bangladesh Police established a specialized unit in 2016 dedicated to counter-terrorism operations, intelligence gathering, and investigation of transnational crimes. What is the name of this specialized unit?

- A. Rapid Action Battalion (RAB)
- B. Special Weapons And Tactics (SWAT)
- C. Counter Terrorism and Transnational Crime (CTTC) unit (correct)**
- D. Anti-Terrorism Unit (ATU)

Explanation: The Counter Terrorism and Transnational Crime (CTTC) unit was established in 2016 under the Dhaka Metropolitan Police to specifically address the growing threats of terrorism and transnational crime, playing a crucial role in post-Holey Artisan counter-terrorism efforts.

5. Harkat-ul-Jihad al-Islami Bangladesh (HuJI-B) is one of the oldest militant groups in Bangladesh, with its origins often traced back to a specific international conflict. Which conflict is most commonly associated with the formation and early membership of HuJI-B?

- A. The Bosnian War
- B. The Soviet-Afghan War (correct)**
- C. The Kashmir conflict
- D. The Iran-Iraq War

Explanation: HuJI-B's origins are widely linked to the Soviet-Afghan War (1979-1989). Many of its founding members and early recruits were Bangladeshi veterans (mujahideen) who fought in Afghanistan and later returned to establish the group in Bangladesh.

Answer Key

- 1. C** New JMB (Neo-JMB)
- 2. B** Jama'atul Mujahideen Bangladesh (JMB)
- 3. C** Assassinations of secular bloggers, writers, and publishers using machetes.
- 4. C** Counter Terrorism and Transnational Crime (CTTC) unit
- 5. B** The Soviet-Afghan War